



Nothing to Kindle in China

Amazon has stopped shipping the Kindle to China for reasons, not about government censorship. <https://digit.in/jun22-81>



Bees are fish now?

A judge rules that bees can be legally identified as fish, although biologically they're still bees. <https://digit.in/jun22-82>

Xiaomi Smart TV 5A

Offers good value for your money

Over the last few months, we've seen some good 43-inch Full HD TVs making their way to the market. Recently, Xiaomi added to the mix, by launching a new TV in the segment – the Xiaomi Smart TV 5A. This particular TV is available in three different sizes. We have with us for review the 43-inch variant of the TV. Let's find out if it's a worthy competitor.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Considering this is a budget TV, the Xiaomi TV does offer better-than-average build quality. The bezels are not too pronounced. The back cover is made out of plastic and houses primarily two HDMI 2.0 ports, two USB 2.0 ports, a 3.5 mm jack and a port for optical audio output. There's also a 2 speaker set-up at the base. All the ports are generally easy to reach, regardless of the fact that it's mounted on a wall or kept on a table. The remote is the same one that we have seen on other more expensive TVs from Xiaomi. It's pretty ergonomic and feels nice in the hand because of its matte textured finish. It also brings a Google Assistant button, OTT hotkeys for Netflix and Prime Video and a volume rocker.

AUDIO AND UI

The audio performance of the device isn't mind-blowing. It is good for the price, but there's still more one could ask for. The engineering team at Xiaomi has done their best in designing the audio chamber for the TV. However, the results still fall short of our expectations. Audio isn't very crisp, and dialogue clarity suffers as a result at times. The bass is also not too punchy, and the sound loses clarity at higher volume levels.

Moving on to UI experience, this is also quite good on the Xiaomi Smart TV 5A. The primary reason behind this is the fact that Xiaomi has equipped



Price
₹25,999

this TV with 1.5GB of RAM – amongst the highest in the segment – which appears to be just about enough to handle this custom UI from the company. This is great because PatchWall has evolved to become a great Android TV alternative.

DISPLAY AND PICTURE QUALITY

At 100 backlight and set to the Movies colour preset, the Xiaomi Smart TV 5A delivered average results in our display tests conducted using Portrait Displays Calman Ultimate paired with Spectral C6 Colourimeter and VideoForge Pro pattern generator.

The TV faltered a little on the colour accuracy front, with the avg deltaE climbing up to 5.9 and max deltaE shooting to 14 at point White. Now, these slightly high deltaE numbers were a surprise to us, as we have previously recorded better numbers testing the Redmi Smart TV 43, which recorded an average delta error of only 2.2. While the average deltaE of 5.9 on the Xiaomi Smart TV 5A isn't, particularly the worst we have seen on a TV, it is definitely not amongst the best.

The grayscale tracking results were also just okay, with the average delta error again on the higher end and a slight red bias. Calman testing also

showed that the panel peaked at 248 nits brightness when set to a 10 per cent window. But how do the numbers translate to real-life performance?

Well, in real life, we found the TV to perform as expected – not great, not too bad, just about adequate-ish. We tested it by playing some movies and shows on it and realised that shows and movies such as American Gods and Jumanji, tuned to best perform in HDR, performed well on the TV in SDR too. It handled most content fine, but in certain scenes, the content did look a little over-saturated. However, the TV offers a good contrast ratio for its price.

VERDICT

Now, to the all-important question, should you

buy the Xiaomi Smart TV 5A? Well, the truth is, this TV from Xiaomi is a good product in isolation. Even though it lacks HDR support, it does do the basics well and offers decent performance for the price. It also looks appealing in the living room, in terms of design and accessibility of ports.

However, before you go buy the Xiaomi Smart TV 5A, we'd still recommend taking a look at another very good TV. For this, we turn your attention towards the Redmi 43-inch FHD Smart TV.

—Sushant Talwar

SPECIFICATIONS

PANEL SIZE: 43-inch | PANEL RESOLUTION: 1920 x 1080p - FHD | PANEL REFRESH RATE: 60Hz | HDR 10 SUPPORT: No | HDR 10+ SUPPORT: No | DOLBY VISION SUPPORT: No | HDMI 2.0 PORTS: 2 | USB PORTS: 2 | BLUETOOTH: Yes, 5.0 | WI-FI: Yes, dual-band | ETHERNET: Yes | SPEAKERS: 24W (DTS:X | DTS Virtual:X) | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 8GB | RAM: 1.5GB

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